DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

Submitted By:

Name: Tanishka Jain

Registration Number: 25BAI10021

Program: B. Tech

Specialization: Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning

Year: First Year

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

VIT Bhopal University

Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh

Introduction

Digital literacy is an essential skill for students in today's technology-driven world. It is not limited to using computers or mobile phones, but also includes the ability to communicate professionally, use digital platforms responsibly, stay safe online, and build a useful online presence. This project was designed to help students understand and apply important digital literacy skills in practical ways.

As part of this assignment, I completed five tasks based on different modules of the course. These tasks included creating an infographic, setting up professional digital profiles, exploring online collaboration and coding platforms, writing formal emails, and studying cybercrime awareness. Through this project, I learned how digital tools can support academics, communication, professional growth, and online safety. Overall, this project helped me improve both my technical understanding and my responsible use of digital platforms.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I created a one-page infographic on the topic **"Digital Literacy for College Students"** using **Canva**. I selected Canva because it is easy to use and provides many useful templates, icons, and design elements for creating educational visuals. The purpose of this infographic was to create awareness among students about the importance of digital literacy in daily academic and online life.

My infographic included important topics such as **what digital literacy means, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette**. I explained that digital literacy is the ability to use digital devices, online tools, and internet resources safely, effectively, and responsibly. I also added examples of useful platforms such as GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Docs, and Canva. In addition, I included key online safety practices like using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and protecting personal information.

The most interesting part of this task was organizing important information in a visually attractive way. The main difficulty I faced was deciding how to include all the important points in a single page without making the design look crowded. Overall, this task helped me understand how digital awareness can be communicated effectively through visual design.

Task 2 – Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I created or updated my profiles on three important digital platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms are useful for students because they help build a professional online presence, showcase academic or technical interests, and support future career development. This task helped me understand that a student's digital identity is important from the very beginning of college.

On GitHub, I created my profile README and added basic details such as my name, branch, year, and a short statement about what I hope to learn during my academic journey. GitHub can be used to store projects, assignments, and technical work. On LinkedIn, I updated my education details, including my current degree, institution name, and expected graduation year. LinkedIn is mainly useful for networking, internships, and professional opportunities. On Kaggle, I created a basic profile to begin exploring the world of data science, machine learning, and technical communities.

In the coming years, I plan to use GitHub to maintain my academic and project work, LinkedIn to build professional connections, and Kaggle to explore learning opportunities and improve technical skills. This task made me realize that creating a clean and professional online presence is an important step toward future academic and career growth.

Task 3 – Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, I explored both a **coding practice platform** and a **cloud collaboration tool**. This helped me understand how different digital platforms can support learning, problem-solving, and academic collaboration. It also showed me that digital literacy includes not only communication and safety, but also practical use of online educational tools.

For the coding practice part, I created an account on **HackerRank** and completed one beginner-level coding challenge. Although the challenge was simple, it gave me a basic idea of how coding platforms work and how they can help students improve logical thinking and programming skills. Such platforms are very useful for regular practice, technical development, and future placement preparation.

For the collaboration part, I created a **Google Form** titled **"Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz"** with exactly five questions related to online awareness and responsible digital behaviour. I included both multiple-choice and short-answer questions. I also linked the form to a **Google Sheet** to observe how responses are collected and organized automatically.

This task helped me understand that digital platforms are useful not only for coding, but also for creating quizzes, collecting responses, and working efficiently in academic environments. These tools will definitely help me throughout my college journey.

Task 4 – Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

This task focused on **professional digital communication**, especially email writing and responsible social media behaviour. In this task, I wrote two formal emails and also created a simple **Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist** for college students. This activity helped me understand how important proper communication is in academic and professional life.

The first email was written from a student to a professor requesting an extension for an assignment submission. The second email was written to an internship coordinator to express interest in a summer internship opportunity. While drafting these emails, I learned the importance of writing a **clear subject line, using a respectful greeting, keeping the message concise, and ending with a proper sign-off**. I understood that professional emails should always be polite, clear, and purposeful.

A situation where poor digital communication can create problems is when a student sends an email without a subject line, uses casual or rude language, or does not clearly explain the purpose of the message. This can create misunderstanding and leave a negative impression. Such problems can be avoided by using proper tone, structure, and etiquette in digital communication. Overall, this task improved my understanding of how to communicate professionally and responsibly in online environments.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

For this task, I selected **Phishing** as my cybercrime topic because it is one of the most common and dangerous online threats faced by students and internet users today. Phishing attacks often look very genuine and can easily trick people into sharing sensitive information such as passwords, OTPs, banking details, or personal data. This made the topic highly relevant and important to study.

In my case study, I explained that phishing usually begins with a fake email, SMS, or online message that appears to come from a trusted source such as a bank, educational portal, shopping website, or delivery service. These messages often create urgency and ask the user to click on a link or verify account details. Once the victim enters information on the fake website, the attacker can misuse it for account access, fraud, or identity theft.

The most surprising thing I learned while researching phishing was how realistic and convincing fraudulent messages can appear. I realized that even careful users can be deceived if they do not verify links and sender details properly. One personal habit I will change is that I will always check messages and websites carefully before responding or entering any information. This task made me more alert and aware about online safety and responsible digital behaviour.

Conclusion:

This Digital Literacy Project was a practical and meaningful learning experience. It helped me understand that digital literacy is not only about using technology, but also about using it **safely, responsibly, and professionally**. Through the five tasks, I learned how to create awareness content, build a professional online presence, use learning and collaboration platforms, communicate through formal emails, and stay safe from cybercrime.

The project also showed me that digital skills are essential for academic success, career development, and personal safety. Each task contributed to a different area of digital awareness and gave me useful knowledge that I can apply in my daily life as a student. Overall, this project improved both my confidence and understanding in the digital world.

References:

1. **Canva** – Used for creating infographic
   https://www.canva.com
2. **GitHub** – Used for repository and profile creation
   https://github.com
3. **LinkedIn** – Used for professional profile creation
   https://www.linkedin.com
4. **Kaggle** – Used for student portfolio platform
   https://www.kaggle.com
5. **HackerRank** – Used for beginner coding practice
   https://www.hackerrank.com
6. **Google Forms** – Used for quiz creation
   https://forms.google.com
7. **National Cyber Crime Portal** – Referenced for cybercrime reporting
   https://cybercrime.gov.in
8. **Project Assignment Brief – CSE0001 Digital Literacy**
   VIT Bhopal University